Bug Bounty Research Tips

Educational Bug Bounty Series • Authorized Security Research Only

■ Bug Bounty Research Tips — Field Notes

Contributed by Cyber_Spy.404 | Educational Bug Bounty Series

Scope: *Perform reconnaissance only on authorized assets. Never use exposed credentials or retrieve private data to prove a point.*

■ Executive Summary

The supplied five-page *tips twitter.pdf* is a collection of field notes spanning authorization/mass assignment, exposed configuration, cloud/CDN behavior, endpoint discovery, default credentials, leaked tokens, sensitive files, reflected XSS, XXE, SVN, Jira, source maps, AngularJS, and Rails IDOR. Treat each note as a lead to validate carefully, not as a guaranteed exploit.

■ Core Testing Methodology

1. Confirm scope and permitted reconnaissance methods.
2. Inventory in-scope domains and public endpoints using program-approved tools and conservative rates.
3. Review client-side code and source maps for accidentally exposed non-secret implementation details; never publish secrets.
4. Check for public configuration artifacts using minimal requests and stop if sensitive content is encountered.
5. Review authorization using controlled accounts, especially role/tenant/object boundaries.
6. Check authentication and default-credential risk only in a lab or where the program explicitly permits it.
7. Validate XSS, XXE, and injection concerns with harmless fixtures in staging.
8. Review public metadata, source-control remnants, and administrative interfaces without extracting private repositories or using leaked credentials.
9. Use program-approved templates and scanners with low request volume.
10. Record impact, scope, evidence, and limitations; report responsibly.

■ High-Value Bug Bounty Tips & Edge Cases

- **Mass assignment:** The source describes a role field appearing in a response and searching code for alternate role names. The defensive lesson is to keep privileged properties server-controlled and verify authorization independently.
- **Cloud/CDN filtering:** The source includes a CloudFront-related XSS bypass idea. CDN behavior varies; validate with harmless test data and focus on origin-side output encoding.
- **Endpoint discovery:** The source recommends gathering URLs and JavaScript files. Limit collection to in-scope assets and avoid indiscriminate scanning.
- **Configuration exposure:** A response status such as 200/404 is not enough; confirm whether content is actually sensitive without copying it.
- **Authentication:** Default credentials and SQL authentication-bypass notes are unsafe to try on live systems without explicit permission.
- **Leaked tokens:** If a token is exposed, do not use it. Report its location with redacted evidence and let the owner verify/rotate it.
- **Recon and fuzzing:** Tools can generate substantial traffic; honor program rate limits and stop on instability.
- **Jira:** The notes mention default credentials and exposed filters/user lists. Validate access boundaries with controlled accounts.

- **SVN/WC metadata:** Repository metadata may expose source history; do not dump repositories.
- **XSS and XXE:** Use non-destructive validation; never exfiltrate cookies, source code, or local files.
- **Source maps and AngularJS:** These may expose implementation details or indicate legacy client-side behavior, but are not vulnerabilities by themselves.
- **Rails IDOR:** Check record-level authorization with two controlled accounts; URL patterns alone do not prove IDOR.
- **Source limitation:** Several notes are brief and some commands are incomplete. This guide preserves the topic categories without treating their claims as verified findings.

■■ Educational Checklists & Safe Examples

```
Asset: [In-Scope-Asset]
Recon source: [Approved Source]
Observation: [Non-Sensitive Summary]
Security boundary: [Expected Policy]
Test account/fixture: [Controlled Test Data]
Result: [Confirmed / Not Reproduced / Inconclusive]
Sensitive data accessed: [No]
Evidence: [Redacted]
```

- [ ] No out-of-scope assets were queried.
- [ ] No leaked credentials or tokens were used.
- [ ] No private source repositories were extracted.
- [ ] Scanning stayed within program limits.
- [ ] All evidence is redacted and reproducible.

■■ Mitigation & Remediation

Enforce server-side authorization, protect secrets and configuration files, rotate exposed tokens, remove development artifacts, use secure defaults, patch legacy components, apply context-aware output encoding, disable unsafe XML features, protect administrative interfaces, and rate-limit automated requests.

■ Source Notes

Based on the supplied five-page *tips twitter.pdf*. Pages 1–2 cover mass assignment, a CloudFront/XSS note, URL and JavaScript discovery, config exposure, SQL-authentication notes, default credentials, Nmap, API/token tips, SSRF/recon, Swagger, and WC/SVN metadata. Pages 3–4 include asset recon, Jira, source maps, reflected XSS, XXE, cookie-related concerns, private information URLs, exposed development portals, leaked GitHub/AWS/Jira credentials, AngularJS, and Rails IDOR. Page 5 continues with the AngularJS and Rails notes. This rewrite omits credential-use and exfiltration instructions.

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